SEWING PATTERN · INSTRUCTION BOOKLET

Circle Skirt

GIRLS DRESS

A twirly full circle skirt on a neat fitted bodice, round neckline, short sleeves and a hidden side zipper.



SIZES	LEVEL	SEAM ALLOWANCE	FORMATS
US 2–18 (12 sizes)	Confident beginner	1 cm (3/8 in) included	A4 · US Letter · A0

HELPFUL VIDEO GUIDES INCLUDED · CLICKABLE LINKS AND QR CODES ON PAGE 8

SewCraftly
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WELCOME

Meet the Circle Skirt Dress

A sweet, timeless party dress for girls, designed to twirl. The simple bodice and the full circle skirt make it a lovely project for a confident beginner, and it works for every season: in cotton for summer, in a light wool blend with tights for winter. Take your time, follow the steps in order and enjoy the result.

Design features

- Fitted bodice with a round jewel neckline, finished with a neat bias facing (no facing pieces to cut)
- Short set-in sleeves with a softly eased cap and a narrow hem
- Full circle skirt in two pieces, cut whole: lots of swish and twirl
- Waist seam at the natural waist (a little higher on sizes 2–6)
- Invisible zipper in the left side seam, across the waist
- Back shoulder darts on sizes 7–18 for a smooth fit over the shoulder blades



What is included

- This illustrated instruction booklet
- Printable pattern files in A4, US Letter and A0, one file per size
- Sizes US 2 to 18 (12 sizes: 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18)
- Helpful video guides with clickable links and QR codes on page 8

GETTING READY

Before You Begin

A few minutes of preparation saves a lot of unpicking. Tick each point before you cut your fabric.

	Before you cut
	Print the test square. Print at 100 % / "Actual size" and measure the 10 cm (4 in) square before printing all the pages.
	Choose the size from the child's chest and waist (page 4), not from age. Between two sizes, choose the larger one: the circle skirt fits at any waist, the bodice is what matters.
	Check the length. Each size is drafted for the height in the size chart. To lengthen or shorten the bodice, change it at the waist seam (front and back the same amount); the skirt is shortened or lengthened at the hem, keeping the curve.
	Transfer every marking: notches, center front / back lines, darts (sizes 7–18), the ZIP notches on the skirt and the two small circles on the sleeve cap.
	Allowances: 1 cm (3/8 in) seam allowance is included on every edge, also on the hems (skirt and sleeves, narrow hem) and the neckline.
	Test on a scrap: stitch length 2.5 mm, and try your invisible zipper foot.
	Trickiest step: the invisible zipper across the waist seam (step 8). Read it once before you start.

Pressing and fabric tip

Pre-wash your fabric the way the dress will be washed. Press every seam as you go: a pressed seam is a neat seam.

A circle skirt has parts cut on the bias, which stretch. Let the finished dress hang for 24 hours before you hem it, then even out the hem if needed (step 9).

About the opening

The dress has no back opening: it goes on over the head with the side zipper open. The ZIP notch on the skirt side seams marks the bottom of the opening; the opening starts 2 cm below the underarm and runs down across the waist seam. Choose the zipper length from the notions table on page 5.

SIZING

Size Charts

Body measurements

Centimetres

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Height	91.4	99.1	106.7	114.3	120.7	127	132	144.8	157.8	162	163.8	165
Chest	53.3	54.6	56.5	58.4	60.3	58.5	63.8	70	75	78.8	82.8	85.2
Waist	48.9	50.5	52.1	54	55.9	52.8	56	59.2	62.2	64	66.2	68
Hips	52.7	54.6	57.5	60.3	63.2	62.8	67.5	75	80.2	85	90.2	92.8

Inches

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Height	36	39	42	45	47 1/2	50	52	57	62 1/8	63 3/4	64 1/2	65
Chest	21	21 1/2	22 1/4	23	23 3/4	23	25 1/8	27 1/2	29 1/2	31	32 5/8	33 5/8
Waist	19 1/4	19 7/8	20 1/2	21 1/4	22	20 3/4	22	23 3/8	24 1/2	25 1/4	26 1/8	26 3/4
Hips	20 3/4	21 1/2	22 5/8	23 3/4	24 7/8	24 3/4	26 5/8	29 1/2	31 5/8	33 1/2	35 1/2	36 1/2

Finished garment measurements (cm)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Chest	57.7	59.1	61.2	63.2	65.3	63.2	68.8	75.3	80.7	84.8	89.1	91.8
Waist	56.6	58	60	62	64.1	61.3	66.4	72.4	77.2	80.8	84.7	87.2
Back length to waist	16.7	17.8	18.9	20.3	20.7	29.2	29.8	32.7	36.3	38.6	39.3	39.6
Skirt length	26.4	28.7	31.1	33.6	35.7	35	36.7	40.4	44.2	45.3	45.8	46.2
Hem sweep	222.5	238.7	255.5	273.3	288.5	281.6	297.2	326	355.1	365.5	372.8	377.5
Sleeve length	14	14.6	15.2	15.8	15.8	16.5	16.6	17.8	19.1	19.9	19.8	19.7

Body measurements are taken over underwear. The finished chest has about 5 cm (2 in) of ease for comfort and movement; the waist seam sits loose (about 10 cm ease) so the dress slips on easily. Skirt length is measured at the side seam from the waist seam to the hem, before hemming. Sizes 2–6 are drafted on a toddler block: a shorter bodice, a softly V-shaped back neckline and no back darts. Measurements are taken from the pattern; please check with your own tape measure.

MATERIALS

Fabric & Notions

Suggested fabrics

Light to medium-weight woven fabrics with a soft drape so the circle skirt falls in nice folds: cotton poplin or lawn, chambray, cotton-linen blends, viscose (rayon) challis, light crepe, or for winter a fine wool or viscose blend. No stretch is needed. Avoid stiff fabrics (denim, canvas) and very thick ones. One-way prints: the skirt pieces are circles, so a one-way print will run sideways at the side seams: choose an all-over print.

Fabric requirements

Size group	150 cm (60 in) wide	115 cm (45 in) wide
US 2–6	1.1 m (1 1/4 yd)	1.5 m (1 3/4 yd)
US 7–10	1.3 m (1 1/2 yd)	1.7 m (1 7/8 yd)
US 12–18	1.8 m (2 yd)	2.4 m (2 5/8 yd)

Estimated by laying out all the pieces of the largest size in each group (skirt pieces cut whole, single layer), plus about 8 % for shrinkage and straightening. Add extra for matching plaids or stripes.

Notions

- Invisible zipper (length per size below); an invisible zipper foot helps a lot
- A bias strip of your fabric for the neckline: 4 cm (1 5/8 in) wide, length per size below (the leftover fabric after cutting is plenty)
- Matching all-purpose thread
- Optional: 2 cm wide stay tape or 1 cm fusible stay tape for the waist seam

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Bias strip, cm	47	48	50	52	53	47	48	50	51	52	53	54
Zipper	25 cm	25 cm	25 cm	25 cm	25 cm	30 cm	30 cm	30 cm	35 cm	35 cm	35 cm	35 cm

A longer zipper is fine: invisible zippers are shortened from the bottom (step 8).

Printing and assembling

- A4 / US Letter: print at 100 %. Each tile is labelled "1/1, 1/2, 2/1…": tiles with the same second number belong to the same column group; match the crosses and corners, overlap and tape.
- A0: send the file to a copy shop and ask for printing at 100 % (no "fit to page").
- The skirt pieces are large half-circles: assemble them on the floor or a big table.

CUTTING

Pattern Pieces & Cutting

#	Piece	Cut from	Cut
1	Front (bodice)	Main fabric	1, single layer
2	Skirt Front	Main fabric	1, single layer
3	Back (bodice)	Main fabric	1, single layer
4	Skirt Back	Main fabric	1, single layer
5	Sleeve	Main fabric	2 (one mirrored)
–	Bias strip (no pattern piece)	Main fabric, on the bias	1, 4 cm wide (length: page 5)

Cutting tips

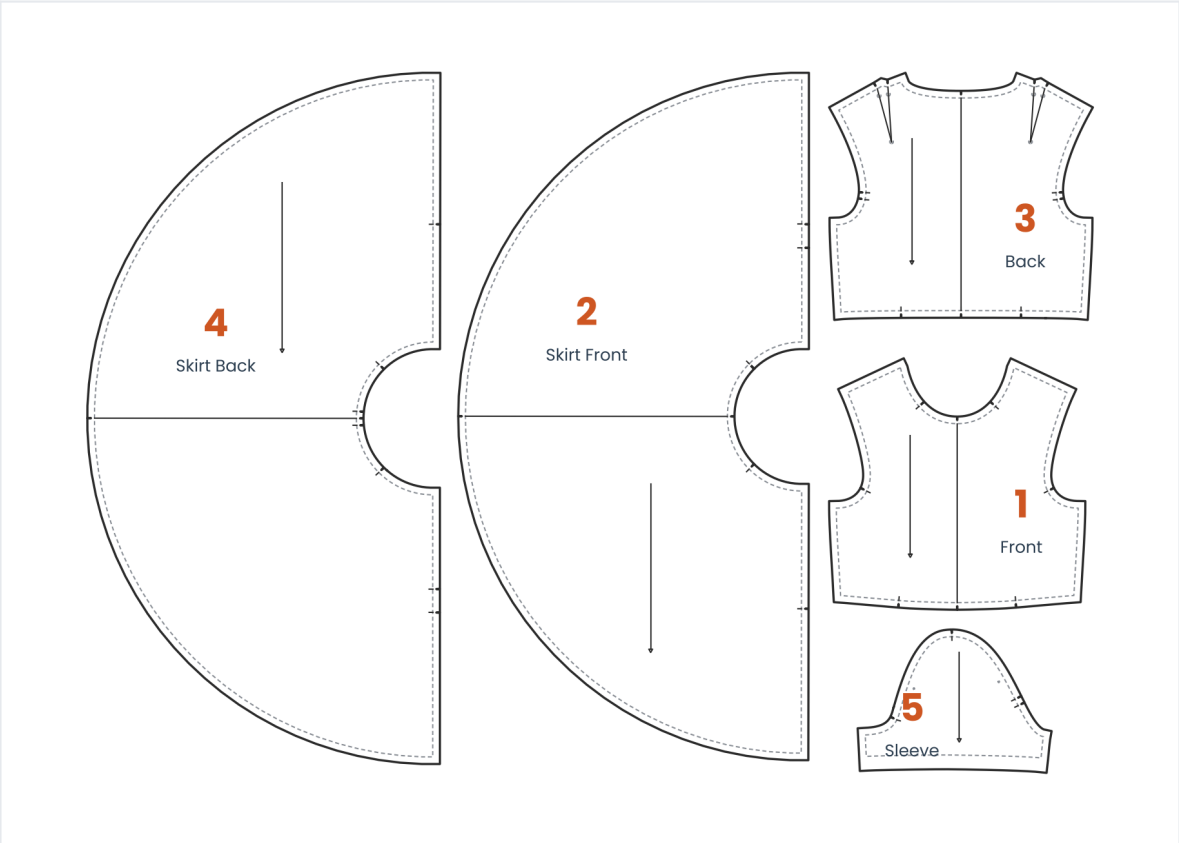
- Every piece is drawn whole (both halves, center line marked): cut it from a single layer of fabric, right side up, not on the fold.
- Follow the grainline arrows: on the skirt pieces the arrow is parallel to the center line.
- Cut the two sleeves as a pair: cut one, then turn the paper over (or fold the fabric right sides together) for the second.
- For the bias strip, fold a corner of the fabric to make a 45° line and cut 4 cm wide strips parallel to it; join strips with a diagonal seam if needed.
- Mark notches with short 3 mm snips into the seam allowance, darts and circles with chalk or a fabric pen.

Sewing order at a glance

1 Darts (7–18)	2 Shoulders	3 Neckline
4 Bodice sides	5 Sleeves	6 Skirt sides
7 Waist seam	8 Invisible zipper	9 Hems & press

MARKINGS

Pieces & Markings



All pattern pieces, size US 8 shown. Solid line = cutting line, dashed line = stitching line (1 cm inside).

- Notches (short lines across the cutting line): match them when pinning. Single notch = front armhole, double notch = back armhole; the notch at the top of the sleeve cap meets the shoulder seam.
- Center front / center back lines on the bodice and the skirt pieces: the middle of each piece. The skirt and bodice center lines meet at the waist seam.
- Waist notches on the bodice and the skirt waist curves: match them at the waist seam (center and quarter points).
- ZIP and the notches on the skirt side seams: on the left side seam. The upper ZIP notch is the bottom of the zipper opening.
- Darts (back, sizes 7–18): two lines meeting at a point with a small circle; sew from the shoulder to the point.
- Two small circles on the sleeve cap ("EASE"): ease the cap between them.
- Grainline arrow: parallel to the selvedge.

LEARN

Helpful Video Guides

Scan a QR code with your phone or click "Watch the video". Each video shows one technique used in this dress.

Sewing darts Watch the video *Step 1*	Sewing a bias facing Watch the video *Step 3*	Easing and setting in a sleeve Watch the video *Step 5*
Sewing a circle skirt Watch the video *Steps 6–7*	Sewing an invisible zipper Watch the video *Step 8*	Hemming a curved edge Watch the video *Step 9*

The videos are made by independent creators and show the technique in general. Always follow the measurements and seam allowances given in this booklet.

SEWING

Sewing Instructions

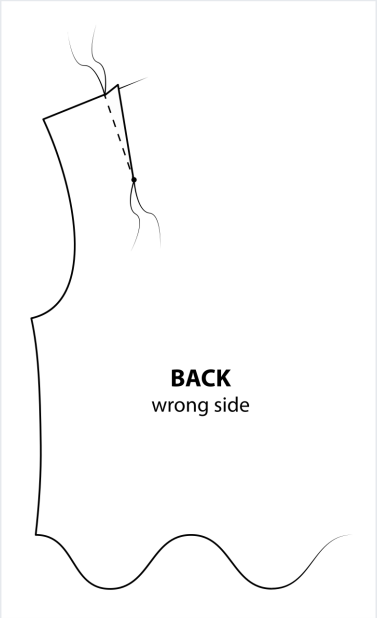
Seam allowance is 1 cm (3/8 in) throughout. Sew with right sides together unless told otherwise. Finish the raw edges of the side seams, shoulder seams and skirt seams with an overlocker or a zigzag stitch before or after sewing, as you prefer.

1 Back shoulder darts

Back · sizes 7–18

- Staystitch the front and back necklines 8 mm from the edge so they do not stretch.
- Sizes 7–18: stitch the shoulder darts on the Back (3) along the marked lines, starting from the shoulder edge and sewing towards the dart point. Backstitch at the beginning, leave a long thread tail at the point.
- Knot the thread tails at the dart point. Press the darts toward the center back.
- Sizes 2–6: there are no darts: just staystitch the necklines.

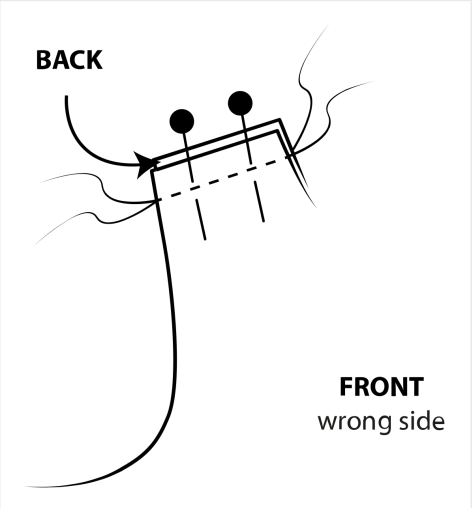
Video help: Sewing darts



2 Shoulders

Front + Back

- With right sides together, pin the Front (1) to the Back (3) at the shoulders, then stitch.
- Finish the seam allowances separately and press open.

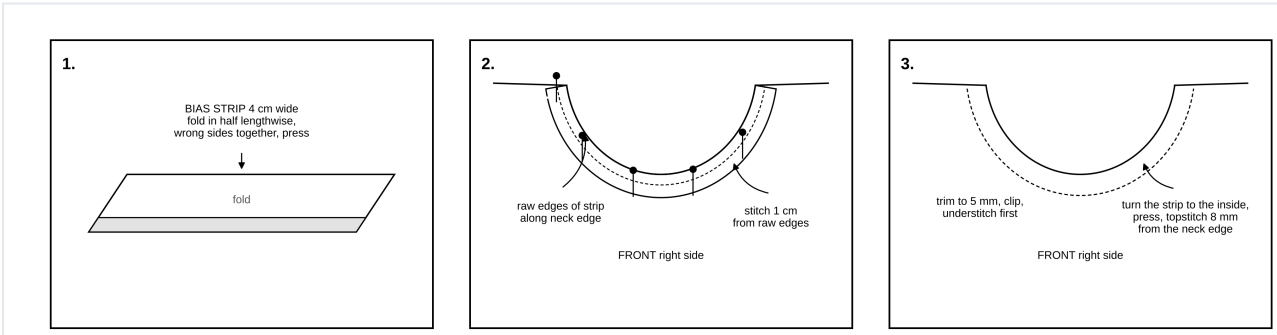


3 Neckline with bias facing

Neckline · pictures 1–3

- Cut a bias strip 4 cm (1 5/8 in) wide, length from the table on page 5. Fold it in half lengthwise, wrong sides together, and press, shaping it into a gentle curve with the iron (picture 1).
- Pin the strip to the right side of the neckline, raw edges together, starting at the left shoulder seam: fold the first end back 1 cm. Stitch 1 cm from the edge all around without stretching the neckline; overlap the end 1.5 cm over the folded start and trim (picture 2).
- Trim the seam allowance to 5 mm and clip into the curve every 1 cm, close to the stitching. Sizes 2–6: clip right into the point of the V at the back.
- Press the strip and the seam allowance away from the dress and understitch close to the seam through the strip and the allowance.
- Turn the strip completely to the inside, press, and topstitch from the right side 8 mm from the neck edge, catching the folded edge of the strip (picture 3). Or slipstitch the fold by hand for an invisible finish.

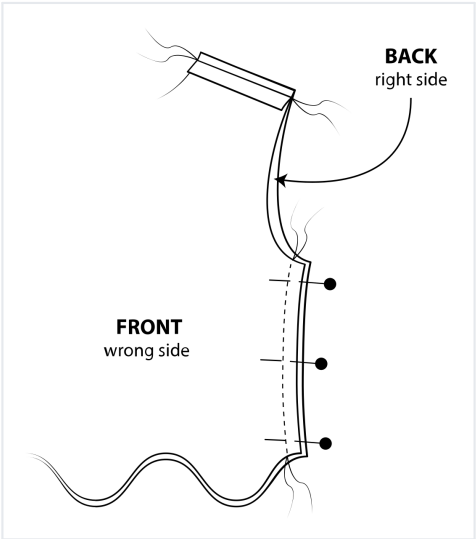
Video help: Sewing a bias facing



4 Bodice side seams

Front + Back

- Right side: with right sides together, pin the Front to the Back at the side, then stitch from the underarm down to the waist.
- Left side (zipper side): stitch only the first 2 cm below the underarm; leave the rest open down to the waist for the zipper.
- Finish the seam allowances separately and press open, also along the opening (press the 1 cm allowance back on the open part).

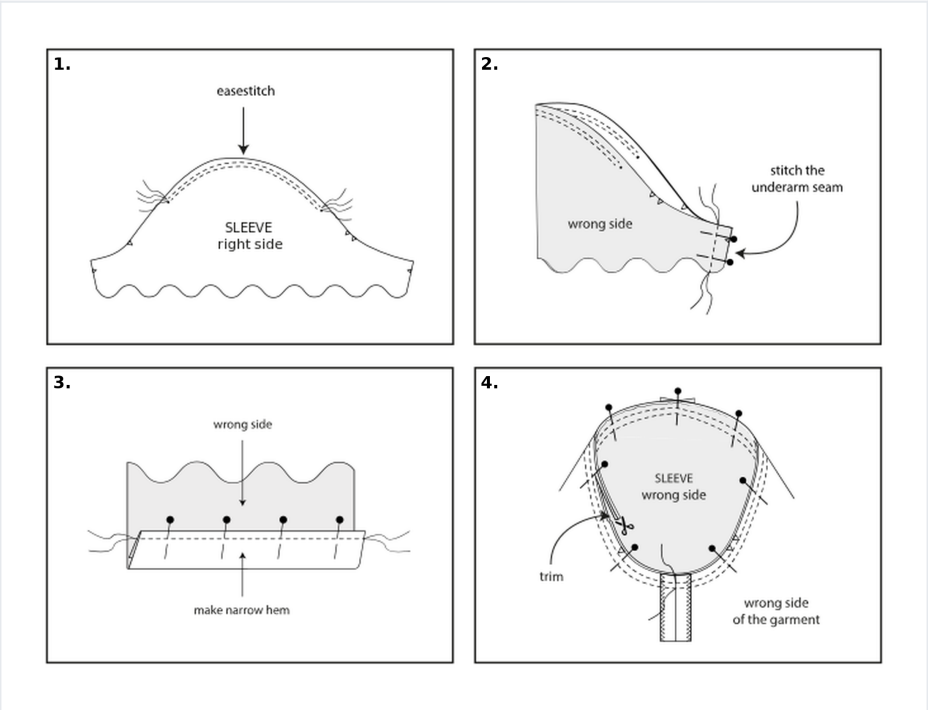


5 Sleeves

Sleeve · pictures 1–4

- Easestitch the sleeve cap between the two small circles, leaving long thread tails: one row at 1.3 cm with a long stitch, a second row 6 mm away inside the seam allowance (picture 1).
- Stitch the underarm seam of each sleeve, right sides together. Finish and press open (picture 2).
- Sleeve hem: turn up 5 mm, press, turn up again 5 mm and stitch close to the fold, using the 1 cm hem allowance (picture 3).
- Insert the sleeve into the armhole, right sides together, matching the underarm seams, the notches (single = front, double = back) and the top notch of the cap with the shoulder seam. Pull the thread tails to ease the cap so it fits without pleats, then baste and stitch (picture 4).
- Stitch again 6 mm away inside the seam allowance, trim and finish the allowances together. Press toward the bodice. Remove the easestitching rows that show.

Video help: Easing and setting in a sleeve

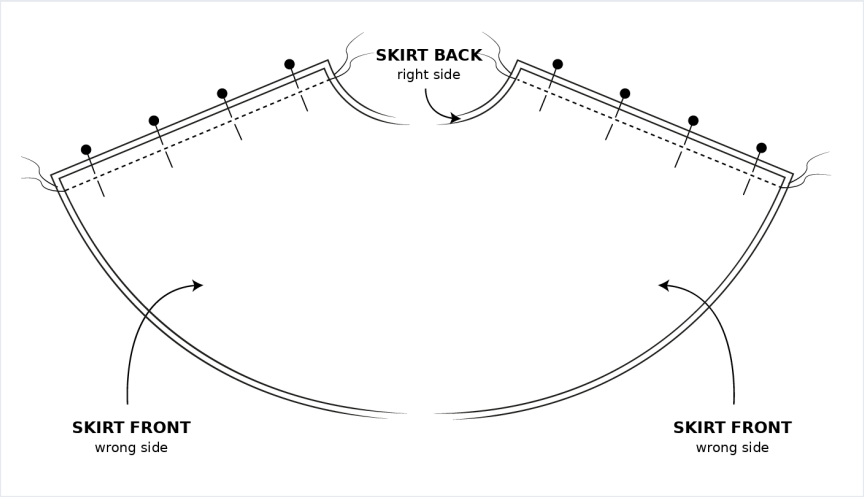


6 Skirt side seams

Skirt Front + Skirt Back

- Pin the Skirt Front (2) to the Skirt Back (4) at the sides, right sides together, matching the notches.
- Right side seam: stitch from the waist down to the hem.
- Left side seam (ZIP notches): stitch from the hem up to the upper ZIP notch only; leave the seam open from that notch up to the waist. Backstitch well at the notch.
- Finish the seam allowances separately and press open (press the allowances back along the opening too).

Video help: Sewing a circle skirt

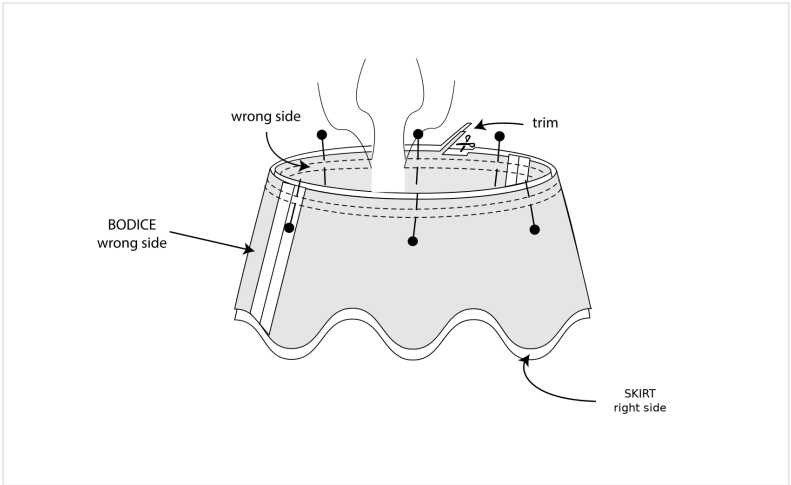


7 Waist seam

Bodice + Skirt

- Staystitch the skirt waist 8 mm from the edge: the curve is partly on the bias and stretches easily.
- Turn the skirt right side out and the bodice inside out. Slip the skirt into the bodice, right sides together, matching the side seams, the openings on the left side, the center front and center back lines and the waist notches. Pin all around; clip into the skirt waist allowance (not past the staystitching) if needed to make it lie flat.
- Stitch 1 cm from the edge. Stitch again 6 mm away inside the seam allowance, trim close to the second row and finish the allowances together.
- Press the seam allowances toward the bodice. Optional: sew stay tape into the seam to keep the waist from stretching.

Video help: Sewing a circle skirt

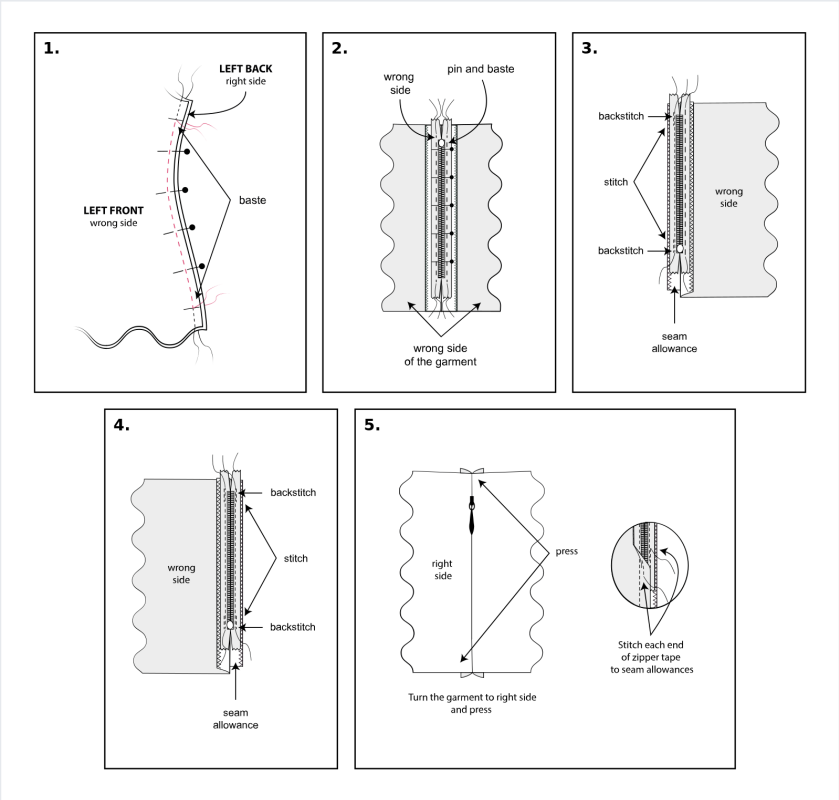


8 Invisible zipper

Left side seam · pictures 1–5

- The opening runs from 2 cm below the underarm, across the waist seam, down to the upper ZIP notch on the skirt. Place the zipper along it: the zipper stop sits just above the bottom of the opening; mark the position of the waist seam on both zipper tapes so the seam meets exactly on both sides.
- Baste the opening closed along the seam line and press it open (picture 1). Pin the closed zipper face down on the seam allowances, teeth on the seam line, and baste (picture 2). Undo the basting stitches that hold the opening together.
- Open the zipper. With the invisible zipper foot, stitch the first tape close to the teeth from the top down to the bottom of the opening, backstitching at both ends (picture 3). Repeat on the other tape, checking that the waist seam marks match (picture 4).
- Close the zipper. At the top, fold the end of the tapes under and hand sew them to the seam allowance so they do not scratch. Stitch each end of the zipper tape to the seam allowances only, keeping the dress free. Turn to the right side and press (picture 5).
- Zipper too long? Shorten it from the bottom: bar-tack over the teeth 1 cm below the end of the opening and cut 2 cm below.

Video help: Sewing an invisible zipper

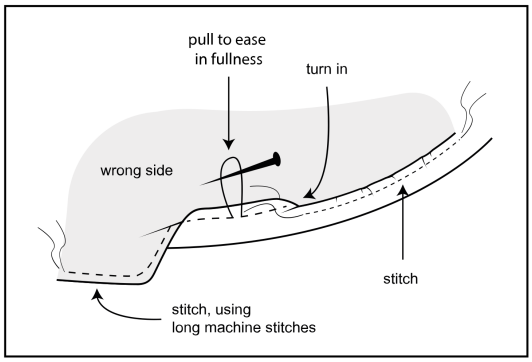


9 Hems and final press

Skirt hem

- Let the dress hang on a hanger for 24 hours, so the bias parts of the circle skirt can drop. Try it on the child (or measure from the floor) and trim the hem even if needed.
- Stitch 5 mm from the lower edge with a long stitch, leaving long thread tails: this line helps to turn the curve smoothly.
- Turn up the hem along the stitching, then turn in again 5 mm (narrow double hem, using the 1 cm hem allowance). Pull the thread slightly to ease the fullness where needed, pin and stitch close to the inner fold. Press.
- Give the whole dress a final press: shoulders, neckline, sleeves, waist seam and the hem.

Video help: Hemming a curved edge



FINISHED

Enjoy Your Circle Skirt Dress



Styling ideas

- Summer: cotton lawn or chambray with sandals and a straw hat
- Party: a soft satin or a viscose print with a ribbon belt at the waist seam
- Winter: a fine wool blend with tights, a cardigan and ankle boots

Care

- Wash as recommended for your fabric, inside out, with the zipper closed.
- Hang to dry so the circle skirt keeps its shape; press on the wrong side.

Need help?
If a step is unclear, email us at contact@sewcraftlypatterns.com – we are happy to help.
Need it in another language? Email us your order number, we send it within 48 h.
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